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Lead Software Developer

HM Revenue and Customs

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 26th November 2026

Reference number

486859

Salary

£60,473 - £67,909

External applicants will join on the pay band minimum.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

HMRC - CDIO - CDPO - Valuation Office Agency

Type of role

Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Belfast Regional Centre - Erskine House, Bristol Regional Centre - 3 Glass Wharf, Cardiff Regional Centre - Ty William Morgan, Edinburgh Regional Centre - Queen Elizabeth House,
Glasgow Regional Centre - Atlantic Square, Leeds Regional Centre - Wellington Place, Worthing - Teville Gate House

About the job

Job summary

Discover a career in your hands at HMRC. Whether you're seeking purpose, growth, or a workplace that gives you a true sense of belonging, hear from some of our employees as they share their story about what it s really like to work at HMRC.

Visit our YouTube channel to watch the full series and come and discover your potential.

The Valuation Office (VO) is currently undertaking a transformation programme to replace legacy applications with Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) and Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) cloud solutions. We are seeking an experienced technical leader with a proven track record of supporting and modernising legacy application estates, whilst setting the strategic direction for the transition to modern SaaS and PaaS cloud solutions.

Job description

As a Lead Developer in HMRC's Chief Digital Product Office (CDPO), supporting the Valuation Office (VO), you will provide technical leadership across a portfolio of business-critical applications and services. You will be responsible for setting technical direction, establishing engineering standards and ensuring the delivery of secure, resilient and maintainable solutions that support VO's operational and strategic objectives.

You will lead teams responsible for the development, support and modernisation of a diverse technology estate, including legacy applications built using Visual Basic 6 and .NET, alongside strategic platforms such as MS Azure and cloud-based applications.

Working closely with architects, delivery teams and business stakeholders, you will balance the demands of operational stability and legacy estate

management with the delivery of technology improvements and modernisation initiatives.

Person specification

You will be responsible for:

Setting technical direction and leading the development, support and modernisation of VO's complex valuation systems and applications that support the administration of Non-Domestic Rating (NDR) and Council Tax.

Leading the support, maintenance and transformation of VO's legacy. Application estate, built on Visual Basic 6, .NET and SQL Server, among other technologies, ensuring business-critical services remain secure, resilient and maintainable while driving their migration to modern Azure-based cloud platforms and services.

Line managing software engineers and technical specialists, fostering a high-performing and inclusive team culture.

Coaching, mentoring and developing engineers at all levels, promoting engineering best practice, continuous improvement and knowledge sharing across teams.

Driving engineering best practice, managing technical debt and supporting the transition of legacy services towards modern cloud-hosted and strategic platforms where appropriate.

Essential Criteria

Significant experience leading the development, support, maintenance and modernisation of a substantial portfolio of business-critical applications across a complex technology estate, including .NET/C#, Visual Basic 6 and VBA.

Experience leading technical transformation from legacy and on-premises solutions to modern SaaS, PaaS and Microsoft Azure cloud services.

Experience leading agile software delivery teams, setting technical direction and engineering standards, and ensuring the successful delivery of secure, resilient and maintainable services, including delivering complex proofs of concept within tight timescales.

Strong technical experience designing, developing and delivering modern applications and services in Microsoft Azure, using technologies such as .NET/C#, App Services, Function Apps, API Management (APIM), Service Bus, Key Vault and Storage Accounts.

Experience working with relational and non-relational databases, including SQL Server, PostgreSQL and MongoDB, and developing database-driven solutions and data access layers (DALs).

Experience applying modern DevOps and engineering practices, including CI/CD and Infrastructure as Code, using technologies such as Azure DevOps, Git, YAML, PowerShell, Bash, Liquibase, Bicep and ARM Templates.

Experience solving complex technical and operational problems and applying API, performance, accessibility, security, monitoring and observability practices to business-critical services.

Experience in line managing, coaching and mentoring software engineers and technical specialists, alongside leading complex 3rd line support and incident management for business-critical services.

Desirable Criteria

Strong knowledge of VO valuation practices and methodologies, including experience of developing, supporting or modernising programmatic valuation tools and systems used in the administration of Non-Domestic Rating (NDR).

Further Location Information

Please ensure that you only apply for a location that you are willing and able to work from, as we will only make one offer of employment. Any additional notes included in a Further Location Preferences (optional) field within the

application form, will not be considered. Please be aware that you cannot change your location preference after submitting your application.

Leeds Location

Moves Adjustment Payment will be available for this role, provided the successful applicant is a current HMRC colleague in Bradford and meets the eligibility requirements outlined in the HMRC s Moves Adjustment Payment guidance.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £60,473, HM Revenue and Customs contributes £17,519 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

HMRC operates both Flexible and Hybrid Working policies, allowing you to balance your work and personal commitments. We welcome applications from those who need to work a more flexible arrangement and will agree to requests where possible, considering our operational and customer service needs.

We offer a generous leave allowance, starting at 25 days and increasing by a day for every year of qualifying service up to a maximum of 30 days.

- Pension - We make contributions to our colleagues Alpha pension equal to at least 28.97% of their salary.
- Family friendly policies.
- Personal support.
- Coaching and development.

To find out more about HMRC benefits and find out what it s really like to work for HMRC hear from our insiders or visit Thinking of joining the Civil Service

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

How to Apply

As part of the application process, you will be asked to provide the following:

A name-blind CV including your job history and previous experiences.

A 750 word Personal Statement. Your Personal Statement should be used to describe how your skills and experience would be suitable for the advertised role, making reference to the Essential Criteria and Person Specification outlined in the advert.

Please evidence any Desirable Criteria where applicable (up to 250 words max). This is not essential for the role but may be considered by the vacancy holder where candidates have the same score at interview.

Further details around what this will entail are listed on the application form.

Sift

In the event of a large number of applications being received, an initial sift may be held on your CV.

At full sift your CV and your Personal Statement, will be assessed, with the successful candidates being invited to interview.

We may also raise the score required at any stage of the process if we receive a high number of applications.

Interview

During the panel interview, your Experience will be assessed through experience-based questions against the Essential Criteria outlined in the advert.

Interviews will take place via video link. Sift and interview dates to be confirmed.

Please note that circumstances may arise that require the planned interview format to change. We will endeavour to provide you with as much notice of any change as possible.

Eligibility

Please take extra care to tick the correct boxes in the eligibility sections of your application form. Mistakes sometimes happen but if you contact us later than two working days (Monday-Friday) before the vacancy closes, we may not be able to reopen your application for you. If you do make a mistake with your eligibility form, or have withdrawn yourself in error and need your application reinstated whilst the campaign is still live, please contact us via: unitybusinessservicesrecruitmentresults@hmrc.gov.uk Use the subject line to insert appropriate wording for example Please re-open my application **[insert vacancy ref]** & vacancy closing date **[insert date] .**

To check that you are eligible to apply for this role, please review the eligibility information before submitting your application.

The HMRC app can help you with your application

The HMRC app can provide you with your past 5 years' employment history, making the process of filling in your application quicker and easier.

If successful in your application, you will need your National Insurance number for the onboarding process.

Download the HMRC app now and save your National Insurance number to your digital phone wallet.

How to download the HMRC app and sign up for an account

Download the free HMRC app from the App Store or Google Play store.

If you have an HMRC online account already, sign straight in using your ID and password. If not, you can prove your identity by answering some questions or providing your photo ID.

You ll then be able to access the app quickly and easily by signing in using a 6-digit PIN, your fingerprint, or facial recognition.

You can find guidance for technical issues on GOV.UK: Technical support with HMRC online services.

Reserve List

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months from which further appointments may be made for the same or similar roles if this applies to you, we ll let you know via your Civil Service Jobs account.

Merit List

After interview, a single merit list will be created, and you will only be considered for posts in locations you have expressed a preference for. Appointments will be made in strict merit order in line with the set number of roles in each location.

Criminal Record Check

Applications received from candidates with a criminal record are considered fairly in accordance with the DBS Code of Practice and the Recruitment of ex-offenders Policy.

Hybrid working at HMRC

HMRC is an office-based organisation, and colleagues are expected to spend 60% of their working time in the office. Our offices provide opportunity for

interaction, collaboration which aids learning and development and a sense of community. Where the role allows it, and where the home environment is suitable, colleagues can work from home for up to 2 days a week, averaged over a calendar month (or a proportionate amount of time for colleagues who work less than full time).

Reasonable Adjustments

We want to make sure no one is put at a disadvantage during our recruitment process. To assist you with this, we will reduce or remove any barriers where possible and provide additional support where appropriate.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact the UBS Recruitment team via unitybusinessservicesrecruitmentresults@hmrc.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you re deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Technical Support

If you are experiencing problems that cannot be resolved by our help section, then technical support is available. You will receive a reply in 2 working days.

Important information for existing HMRC contractual homeworkers

This role may be suitable for existing HMRC employees who are contractual homeworkers. Occasional attendance to the office will be required where there is a business need. Please consider the advertised office locations for this role when applying and only select locations from the location preferences section that you can travel to.

Terms and Conditions

Customer facing roles in HMRC require the ability to converse at ease with members of the public and provide advice in accurate spoken English and/or Welsh where required. Where this is an essential requirement, this will be tested as part of the selection process.

HMRC has a presence in every region of the UK. For more information on where you might be working, review this information on our locations (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service values honesty and integrity and expects all candidates to abide by these principles. The evidence you provide in your application must relate to your own experiences.

Any instances of plagiarism or other forms of cheating will be investigated and, if proven, the relevant application(s) will be withdrawn from the process.

Recording of interviews is prohibited unless explicit agreement is sought in line with the UK General Data Protection Regulations.

Questions relating to an individual application must be emailed as detailed later in this advert.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant s details held on the IFD will be refused employment.

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5 year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

New entrants will join on the minimum of the pay band.

Please note that, if you are applying for roles on a part-time basis, the salary agreed will be pro-rata, reflective of the working hours agreed within your contract.

If you experience accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

For more Information for people applying for, or thinking of applying for, roles at HM Revenue and Customs, please see link: Working for HMRC: information for applicants - GOV.UK.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a standard (or equivalent) criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Paul Cantone

Email : paul.Cantone1@HMRC.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : unitybusinessservicesrecruitmentresults@hmrc.gov.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission s Recruitment Principles. You have the right to complain if you feel there has been a breach of the Recruitment Principles.

In the first instance, you should raise the matter directly via ubsrecruitmentcomplaints@hmrc.gov.uk . Please note that we do not accept complaints or appeals regarding scoring of outcomes of campaigns unless candidates can provide clear evidence that the campaign did not follow the Recruitment Principles.

If you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their website.

Civil Service Commission

disability confident LEADER